

> Should I just boost the power on the speaker?

No, if you turn it up to eleven, you'll overheat the amplifier and it might explode.

Say:

> Should I just boost the power on the speaker?

NO!!!! If you turn it up to eleven, you'll overheat the amplifier and IT MIGHT EXPLODE!!

Note that you should use capital letters sparingly. Just as loss of sight can lead to improved hearing, the relative lack of cues to emotion in e-mail makes people hyper-sensitive to any cues that might be there. Thus, capital letters will convey the message that you are shouting.

It is totally inappropriate to use all capital letters in a situation where you are calm. Don't do this:

HEY, I JUST WANTED TO SEE IF YOU HAD MADE ANY PROGRESS ON THE WILLIAMS ACCOUNT. STOP BY AND SEE ME SOMETIME.

People will wince when they read that e-mail.

### Smileys or Emoticons

A facial gesture can be represented with what is called a "smiley" or "emoticon": a textual drawing of a facial expression. The most common ones are:

:) or :-) happy, friendly

;) or ;-) droll, ironic

>:) or >:-) devilish, teasing

:O or :O shocked, bewildered

:( or :-( sad, displeased

>:( or >:-( angry